

RESTORE DRILL · A POSITION PAPER

A backup you have never restored is not a backup.

RPO and RTO written into a document are a claim. A restore drill is the only evidence — and the gap between them is where recovery plans die.

PRESENTER · TEAM

No RPO or RTO figures are asserted in this deck — those numbers are yours to set and to measure.

THE SILENT FAILURES

What a backup fails at, silently

Media nobody has read back

The job succeeded. The bytes never did.

A schema left out of the dump

Rows come back. The database does not.

A dependency that is down too

The restore needs what the outage took.

Credentials nobody on shift has

The path exists. Nobody can walk it.

None of these announce themselves. All of them wait.

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THE SHAPE OF THE DATA

A drill proves nothing against a toy dataset

A SAMPLE RESTORE

It proves the command exists.

It proves someone on the team can type it.

A PRODUCTION-SHAPED RESTORE

It proves the volume moves
in the time you promised.

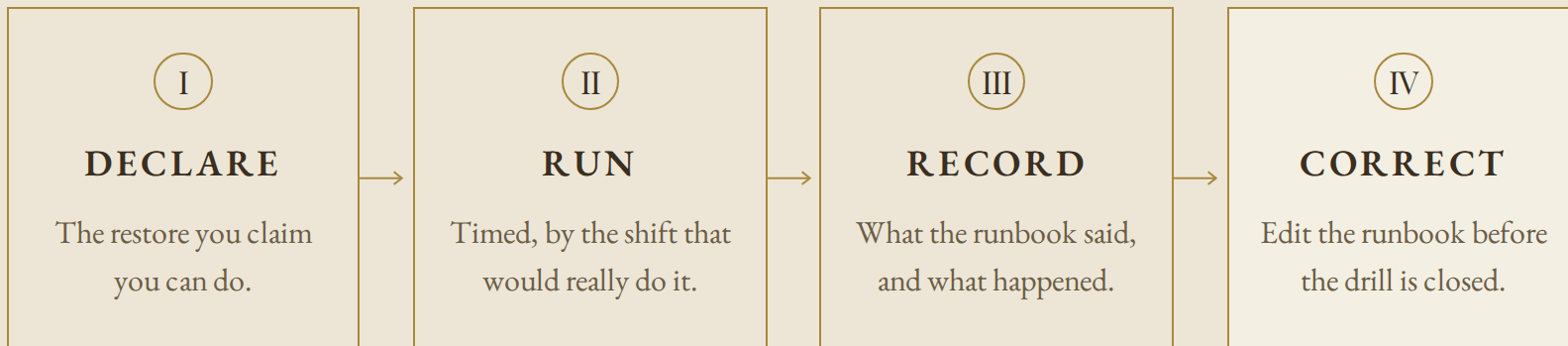
It proves the schema, the permissions
and the dependencies come back with it.

Everything that breaks at real size is invisible at sample size.

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WHAT THE DRILL PRODUCES

The drill's product is a corrected runbook



A drill that ends in a pass has thrown away its only output.

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DECISIONS

What we need to decide

I

Does the drill go on the calendar?

A date and an owner, or it stays an intention.



II

What stops while the drill runs?

Name the service that goes quiet, and who is told before it does.



III

Who signs the numbers we publish?

The signature belongs to whoever watched them measured.

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